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Your PDP is costing you more than your ads are.

1 mensagem

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Happy Sunday!

Last week I was on a call with a brand doing about \$14M a year. Good product, solid retention, decent creative. Their conversion rate on paid traffic was sitting at 1.1%. They thought they had a traffic problem. They did not have a traffic problem. They had an explaining their work problem.

I pulled up their PDP. Giant lifestyle image, product name, price, add to cart. Reviews at the bottom. No headline. No hook. No reason for someone who had never heard of them to care.

They were spending \$400k a month sending people to a page that was doing almost nothing to close the sale. This is more common than it should be. And I get why it happens... most founders and operators think about the ad, the offer, the email. The PDP feels like a given. You built it once and moved on. But for most DTC brands, the product page is where the money is actually made or lost, and it gets a fraction of the attention it deserves.

Before we get into it...

Vendor of the Week

Every conference I've been to in the last 2 years has the same format: hotel ballroom, recycled panel topics, and hallway networking that feels more like speed dating than actual relationship building. The content is fine, but the format hasn't evolved since 2015!

[RetailClub AI Festival](#) is doing something completely different. It's the only entirely outdoor retail event, taking place September 22-24 in Huntington Beach, CA. Instead of expo halls, you're walking a 1/3 mile boardwalk along the shoreline that connects three stages, 250+ sponsors, 150+ speakers, and 50+ curated experiences ranging from workshops and tastings to yoga sessions and dinners.

But the format isn't even the main draw... What makes this one worth paying attention to is the focus: helping the retail, brand, and consumer goods ecosystem figure out how to actually move from "AI experimentation" to full-scale transformation. Not surface-level keynotes about ChatGPT. Real operator-led sessions on what's working, what's not, and where AI is genuinely changing the game across the customer experience.

Two things that stood out to me:

- Every speaker is selected based on expertise, which is rare.
- 30,000+ pre-scheduled 1:1 meetings, so every meeting you take is with someone who actually wants to be in that conversation.

If you're a decision-maker at a retailer or brand, you can get a **free ticket plus up to \$1,250 in travel/hotel reimbursement**.

[Check it out and grab your spot here.](#)

Scaling Ad Spend

Most people think TV ads are a brand awareness play. [They're not](#). I'm hosting a free session on April 29th breaking down how to run CTV ads with the same targeting, measurement, and attribution logic you already use on Meta.

If you want your Meta ads to work harder than they are right now, [come hang](#).

Limited Supply

This past week on Limited Supply, I went deep into the ClawdBot setup. Step by step, I broke it down and if you've been thinking about getting your own OpenClaw/MoltBot setup... I will walk you through getting it setup in less than 45 minutes. My mom was able to listen to this episode and setup an OpenClaw for herself.

Here's how I think about a PDP

Every person who lands on your product page got there somehow. Maybe they clicked an ad. Maybe an influencer sent them. Maybe they found you through search. Whatever the path, by the time they're on your page, you've already paid for that click. The ad spend is gone. The only question left is whether the page converts them or doesn't.

And here's the thing, most people who land on a PDP are not ready to buy. They're deciding. They came in with a question, not a credit card. Your job is to answer every question they have, remove every reason they might leave, and make buying feel like the obvious next step. The brands I see doing this well don't have better products than the brands doing it poorly. They just have better pages.

So let's go through what's actually missing.

Above the fold

The first thing someone sees when they land on your page is your above-the-fold content. On mobile, that's roughly the top 600 to 700 pixels of the screen. Everything that lives in that space needs to earn its placement.

The most common layout I see: a product image that takes up half the screen, a product name, a price, a variant selector, and an add to cart button. Sometimes a short paragraph underneath. That's it.

The problem is that layout does zero selling. It presents the product. It doesn't make a case for it.

Your ATF content needs to answer three things before someone scrolls: what is this, why should I care, and how do I get it. If you assume someone already knows the answer to any of those, you're making a mistake. Most people landing on your page from a paid ad have seen your creative for three seconds. They don't know your brand. They don't know your product. They clicked because something caught their eye, and now they need a reason to stay.

Start with a real headline. Not the product name, that's not a headline, that's a label. A headline makes an argument. "The only magnesium formula that actually helps you stay asleep" is a headline. "Magnesium Glycinate 400mg" is something you'd read on the side of a bottle. One of those makes me want to keep reading.

Under that, one sentence that tells me what makes yours different. Specific beats vague every single time. "Clinically studied dose of ashwagandha, not the token amount most brands use" hits differently than "premium adaptogen formula." If you have a real differentiator, say it plainly.

CTA copy is one of the most underrated levers on a product page. "Add to cart" works but it has no personality and no momentum. I've seen brands move their conversion rate just by changing button copy to something that feels like the start of something: "start my 30-day reset," "try it risk-free," "build my bundle." It sounds small. It's not.

If you have a subscription offer, show both prices above the fold. I can't tell you how many brands bury this in the product options or hide it in a small toggle below the CTA. The savings gap between one-time and subscribe is a conversion lever. Surface it. Let someone see they're saving \$18 per order just by subscribing before they've even decided if they want the product.

And get your star rating and review count under the product name. Right there. Not in a tab. Not at the bottom. Before someone has read a single line of copy, seeing 4.8 stars and 2,400 reviews tells them everything they need to know about whether other people trust this product. That's the fastest trust signal on the page and most brands don't put it where it actually gets seen.

Visual storytelling

Here's a stat I think about a lot: somewhere between 75 and 85 percent of your site traffic is on mobile. On a phone screen, with someone scrolling with their thumb while they're half-watching something else, a paragraph of text is not a compelling experience. People don't read product pages. They scan them.

Visual storytelling is how you communicate to people who won't slow down long enough to read. And it's the gap I see most often when I'm doing audits.

A few things that actually move the needle:

Icon strips with short benefit labels are one of the most efficient tools on a PDP. Three to five icons, two to four words each. "Third-party tested." "No artificial fillers." "30-day guarantee." "Ships same day." Someone can process that entire strip in under two seconds and walk away knowing the most important things about your product. A paragraph takes 20 seconds to read and most people won't.

A how-it-works module matters more than most brands think. If your product has any complexity to it (a supplement protocol, an air purifier with stages, a skincare routine), walk someone through it visually. Three steps with icons. This reduces confusion and builds confidence at the same time. When someone understands how something works, they're more likely to believe it'll work for them.

UGC video is probably the single highest-leverage thing you can add to a PDP right now. Not a brand video. Not a polished shoot. A real customer, on their phone, talking about what changed after using the product. 45 seconds. Vertical. Unscripted. These consistently outperform produced video because people trust people. If you're not actively collecting this from your customers, that's the first thing I'd fix.

One thing worth flagging: AI-generated images are everywhere and people can spot them faster than brands realize. The slightly uncanny product shots, the backgrounds that look a little off, the hands that aren't quite right. Use AI for iteration and exploration, it's useful for that. Just don't let it be the face of your brand on the page where people are deciding whether to spend their money.

Social proof

Every time I bring this up in an audit, I hear the same thing: "we already have reviews at the bottom of the page."

Yes. And roughly 15 percent of your visitors make it there. Social proof is not a section you put at the bottom and check off the list. It's a layer that lives throughout the entire page. The goal is to make someone feel, by the time they reach the CTA, that buying is the obvious move — not because you told them your product is great, but because everyone else has already confirmed it.

Here's how I think about placement:

Above the fold, as I mentioned, star rating and review count under the product name. That's table stakes.

Mid-page, pull two or three of your best reviews and treat them like editorial quotes. Big text. Customer name and photo if you have it. Place them at natural pause points in the scroll... after a benefit section, after a how-it-works module. Let a customer make the argument you've been making, in their own words.

If you have press coverage, use it. A logo strip with recognizable media names is one of the fastest credibility signals you can put on a page. The reader's brain sees a familiar logo and does the work for you. You don't need a paragraph explaining the coverage. The logo is enough.

Authority endorsements are genuinely underutilized. A doctor, a dietitian, a certified trainer (whoever is credible in your category). You don't need a video. A photo, a name, a title, and one sentence. That's enough to shift someone's perception of the product from "thing I saw in an ad" to "thing a professional trusts."

The logic underneath all of this is simple. You're not trying to force a sale. You're trying to show someone that people like them ones they'd trust have already made this decision and were glad they did. That's the most persuasive thing you can put on a page, and it has to be distributed across the whole page to do its job.

Navigation and UX

This is the one that gets underestimated the most, and it's where I've seen brands lose sales they had basically already won. You can have a great headline, great visuals, strong social proof but still lose the conversion because the page is confusing to move through. A pop-up fires three seconds after landing. A chat bubble is covering the CTA. There are four different buttons competing for attention and none of them clearly stand out. Someone who was close to buying gets confused, pauses, and closes the tab.

Friction is where conversions go to die.

The fix is not complicated. You need one clear path to purchase and everything on the page should point toward it. One dominant CTA. Visually distinct. Different color, larger, impossible to miss. Everything else on the page is secondary and should look secondary. When someone is ready to buy, there should be zero ambiguity about what to tap.

A sticky add to cart bar should appear on scroll. As someone moves down the page, a slim bar at the top or bottom of the screen with the product name, the rating, and the CTA button. This means no matter where someone is on the page (reading a review, looking at the ingredients, watching the UGC video) they always have a path to purchase one tap away. If you don't have this, add it this week.

An FAQ module is one of the most underrated conversion tools on any product page. Every person who leaves without buying had a reason. Wasn't sure about shipping. Didn't understand the return policy. Wasn't sure if the product was right for their situation. A good FAQ module handles those objections before someone goes looking for a reason to leave. Cover the five things people always ask: shipping time, return policy, what's in it, who it's for, and how long until they see results. That's it.

Your bundle or upsell module belongs on the PDP, not in the cart. By the time someone is at checkout, they're in transaction mode. They're thinking about completing the purchase they already decided to make, not adding more. But mid-PDP, after someone has read through the page and is forming a positive opinion? That's the moment. "Most customers also grab" or "complete your routine" placed at that point in the scroll will do more for your AOV than any cart upsell.

The checklist

Everything above, in a format you can hand off.

Above the fold

- Headline leads with the outcome, not the product name
- One-line differentiator — specific, not generic
- CTA visible without scrolling
- CTA copy is action-oriented ("start my reset," "try risk-free") not just "add to cart"
- Subscription savings shown above the fold if applicable
- Star rating and review count under the product name

Visual storytelling

- Icon strip with 3 to 5 short benefit labels
- How-it-works graphic or step module
- Comparison module vs. competitor or old alternative
- UGC video- real customer, vertical, short, unscripted
- GIF or looping demo clip if product has a tactile component
- Everything tested at 375px mobile width
- No AI-generated imagery as primary creative

Social proof

- Star rating badge next to add to cart button
- 2 to 3 pulled reviews placed mid-page as callout quotes
- Press or media logo strip near top of page
- Authority endorsement — photo, name, title, one sentence
- Best seller or momentum badge if applicable
- UGC photos or video embedded on page

Navigation and UX

- One dominant primary CTA, visually distinct from everything else
- Sticky add to cart bar on scroll
- Pop-ups timed thoughtfully. not firing in the first 3 seconds
- FAQ module covers shipping, returns, ingredients, who it's for, timeline
- Bundle or upsell module on PDP before checkout
- Page flows from awareness to education to purchase
- No ambiguous buttons or links

That's all for this week

If you run through this list and your PDP is missing more than half of it, you already know what the problem is. Pick the highest-leverage items first (ATF headline, star rating placement, UGC video, sticky CTA) and work down from there. You don't have to do it all at once. But every day your page sits the way it is, you're paying for traffic you're not converting.

If you run TikTok Shop, everything above applies to your product card too. I see brands put real thought into their website PDP and then treat the Shop card like an afterthought. Max out every field. Title, bullet points, images, video. The algorithm rewards complete listings and your conversion happens right there in the app. Treat it like a mini PDP, because that's exactly what it is.

It's Sunday night, so I hope you plan to get a full 9 hours of sleep tonight and have an incredible upcoming week. See you next Sunday evening!

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